

# Brotherhood

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

## CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

### SCENE 5 — BROTHERHOOD

#### TRANSITION FROM SCENE 4

**Scene 4 ends somewhere else in Nazareth with the dangerous echo: 'That's what I heard.'**

*One beat.*

#### **BANG!**

*A hammer strikes wood.*

#### **BANG!**

*A second strike.*

#### **BANG-BANG!**

*Lights cut to Joseph's work area. The tonal shift should be immediate: warmth, laughter, physical energy.*

*JOSEPH, LEVI, MALACHI, CALEB, and EZRA are already working together. The unfinished table from Scene 2 is now unmistakably the project.*

*The satchel Mary made Joseph is on him. Do not feature it yet.*

*A hand slaps a workbench.*

*Suddenly—*

#### **JOSEPH'S WORLD.**

*Bright.*

*Alive.*

*Rhythmic.*

*JOSEPH, LEVI, MALACHI, CALEB and EZRA are already working.*

*They do not stand in a line.*

*The worksite is constantly moving*

#### **wood passes from hand to hand;**

*tools change owners;*

*measurements are called;*

*benches move;*

*pieces are lifted;  
someone climbs;  
someone ducks;  
someone catches something at the last second.  
Everything feels practiced.  
These men have worked together for years.*

## **WORK BEFORE WORDS**

*Do not begin with dialogue. Let the audience watch the men work.*

*Joseph checks a length. Levi takes weight. Ezra checks alignment. Malachi steadies a piece. Caleb tries to help and is just useful enough to remain employed.*

*The physical vocabulary beneath the sequence is MEASURE -> MARK -> CUT -> SET. It may be expressed through movement rather than repeated as lyrics.*

**Hammer strikes, scraping wood, footwork, hand-claps, and safe prop percussion begin to align into a musical pulse.**

### **JOSEPH**

Hold that.

### **CALEB**

I am holding it.

### **EZRA**

You're leaning on it.

### **CALEB**

That is a form of holding.

### **LEVI**

Move.

*Levi takes the weight cleanly.*

### **CALEB**

See? Teamwork.

### **MALACHI**

That is not what happened.

### **CALEB**

It's what I experienced.

*They keep working. The rhythm continues underneath.*

## **JOSEPH IN HIS ELEMENT**

*Joseph stops and looks at a piece Caleb has handled.*

**JOSEPH**

Caleb.

**CALEB**

What?

*Joseph points at it.*

**JOSEPH**

Look at it.

*Caleb looks.*

**CALEB**

I am.

**JOSEPH**

And?

*Caleb studies it harder.*

**CALEB**

Strong.

**JOSEPH**

Caleb.

**CALEB**

Very strong.

*Ezra steps over, looks once.*

**EZRA**

One side is higher.

**CALEB**

Only if you compare it to the other side.

*Beat.*

**LEVI**

That's usually how sides work.

*Joseph takes the piece from Caleb.*

**CALEB**

You don't trust my work.

**JOSEPH**

I trust you completely.

*Caleb softens, pleased.*

**CALEB**

Thank you.

**JOSEPH**

Your work is another matter.

*The men laugh. Joseph resets the piece, and the music/movement picks back up.*

**MARRIAGE BANTER**

*Levi notices Joseph working on another piece.*

**LEVI**

Hold on.

Whose is that?

**JOSEPH**

Customer's.

**EZRA**

No.

**JOSEPH**

No?

**EZRA**

Different wood.

Different finish.

*Ezra watches Joseph inspect the table.*

**EZRA**

And you've checked that corner four times.

**CALEB**

Four?

*He GASPS.*

**CALEB**

Oh, we've lost him.

**JOSEPH**

I'm standing right here.

**LEVI**

That's for Mary.

*Joseph continues working.*

**LEVI**

Too late. They know.

**CALEB**

It's for the house!

**JOSEPH**

Caleb—

**CALEB**

He's building the house!

**LEVI**

Man hasn't even married her, and he's already building furniture.

**MALACHI**

At least he'll have somewhere to sleep after she gets tired of him.

*Joseph looks at Malachi.*

**JOSEPH**

You too?

**MALACHI**

Wisdom comes in many forms.

**EZRA**

This one appears to be a table.

*Joseph stops. Looks at Ezra.*

**EZRA**

What?

It's obviously a table.

**CALEB**

How big is this thing?

**JOSEPH**

Big enough.

**EZRA**

That is not a measurement.

**LEVI**

Who's sitting at it?

**JOSEPH**

People.

**CALEB**

How many people?

**JOSEPH**

Six.

*Ezra looks at the table.*

**EZRA**

That's not a six-person table.

**JOSEPH**

It might be eight.

*Beat.*

*Caleb slowly turns toward Joseph.*

**CALEB**

Eight?

*Joseph keeps working.*

**CALEB**

Joseph.

**JOSEPH**

What?

**CALEB**

Eight?

**JOSEPH**

People visit.

**LEVI**

Of course.

**EZRA**

Very small people, apparently.

*Caleb realizes.*

**CALEB**

Children.

**JOSEPH**

I didn't say that.

**CALEB**

You built it.

*The others laugh.*

**CALEB**

How many?

**JOSEPH**

Caleb.

**CALEB**

You've counted.

**JOSEPH**

I have not.

**EZRA**

He has.

**JOSEPH**

Ezra.

**EZRA**

Evidence suggests—

**JOSEPH**

Nobody asked for evidence.

**LEVI**

Eight means there's room.

*Joseph's defensiveness softens.*

**JOSEPH**

That's the idea.

**MALACHI**

Room for what?

*Joseph looks at the table.*

*This time he answers without joking.*

**JOSEPH**

Family.

Friends.

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**

Whoever needs a place.

That quiets them for just a moment.

Then—

**CALEB**

And children.

**JOSEPH**

Go cut something.

**CALEB**

Gladly.

*Caleb grabs the appropriate piece and launches back into the work.*

**JOSEPH**

Not that one.

*Caleb freezes.*

**CALEB**

I knew that.

**EZRA**

Evidence suggests—

**CALEB**

Nobody asked for evidence.

*The men laugh.*

*The men laugh and return to the work rhythm. Joseph tries to hide how pleased he is, which only confirms everything.*

## **SATCHEL CONTINUITY**

*Caleb reaches for a tool and notices Joseph's satchel.*

**CALEB**

You still carrying that?

**JOSEPH**

It's a tool satchel.

**CALEB**

Then where are the tools?

*Joseph instinctively checks.*

*The others notice the satchel is nearly empty.*

**EZRA**

Interesting.

**JOSEPH**

Don't.

**CALEB**

She made you a satchel, and now you're protecting it from the tools.

**JOSEPH**

I use it.

**LEVI**

For what?

*Joseph looks at all of them.*

**JOSEPH**

For carrying things.



**CALEB**

Like feelings?

*Joseph throws a rag at Caleb. Caleb catches it triumphantly.*

**CALEB**

See? Now it's useful.

*Back into the work.*

**“BROTHERHOOD” BEGINS**

*The carpentry pulse now expands into the full Brotherhood sequence.*

*This should feel rehearsed and exciting, but never disconnected from the work. The men are not presenting choreography to the audience; they are working so instinctively together that the work becomes choreography.*

*Movement possibilities: passing wood in counter-rhythm; coordinated lifts; safe tool-handling phrases; turns generated by carrying material; foot-stomps; hand-claps; bench/wood percussion; a repeated lift-set-release pattern; Caleb adding unnecessary flourishes that the others repeatedly correct.*

*Joseph should eventually stop supervising every beat and fully join the physical joy. We need to see him young, competitive, laughing and completely at home with these men.*

**PERCUSSIVE PATTERN**

**HAMMER — HAMMER — SAW — CLAP — FOOT**

**HAMMER — HAMMER — SAW — CLAP — FOOT**

*The men begin passing tools in rhythm.*

*Movement becomes sharper.*

*Angular.*

*Masculine.*

*Precise.*

*The dialogue starts locking into tempo.*

**LEVI**

Measure.

**EZRA**

Mark.

**CALEB**

Cut.

**MALACHI**

Again.

**JOSEPH**

Lift.

**ALL**

Set.

**BANG!**

**CALEB**

Too high!

**EZRA**

Too low.

**LEVI**

Move!

**MALACHI**

Slow.

**JOSEPH**

Together.

**HIT.**

*The piece lands perfectly.*

## **RHYTHMIC SPOKEN SECTION**

**LEVI**

If it's heavy—

**CALEB**

We lift it.

**EZRA**

If it's crooked—

**JOSEPH**

We fix it.

**MALACHI**

If it's broken—

**LEVI**

We mend it.

**CALEB**

If it's food—

**ALL**

CALEB!

**CALEB**

I was going to say share it.

**EZRA**

No, you weren't.

*The audience laughs.*

*The work continues.*

**LEVI**

Side by side—

**MALACHI**

Hand to hand—

**EZRA**

Know the measure—

**JOSEPH**

Know the plan—

**CALEB**

And if the plan goes bad—

*Everyone stops.*

*Looks at Caleb.*

**CALEB**

We blame Ezra.

**EZRA**

Why me?

**CALEB**

You look responsible.

The rhythm immediately resumes.

**“BROTHERHOOD” — CALL AND RESPONSE**

*This portion may become sung/spoken/rap-adjacent depending on Christian's composition.*

*The text can ultimately be shaped musically, but the dramatic territory is*

**JOSEPH**

You don't build alone.

**MEN**

No.

**LEVI**

You don't stand alone.

**MEN**

No.

**MALACHI**

When one man loses his footing—

**MEN**

We hold him.

**EZRA**

When one man misses the measure—

**CALEB**

We tell everybody.

**EZRA**

That's not—

**JOSEPH**

Caleb!

Laughter inside the rhythm.

Then—

**ALL**

**THE BROTHERHOOD**

*Work together.*

*Stand together.*

*Build together.*

**BANG!**

**ALL**

*Brothers don't let brothers fall.*

The phrase should land clearly enough to return emotionally later.

**CHOREOGRAPHIC FEATURE**

*The music expands into approximately 20–30 seconds of instrumental choreography.*

*This is the major visual payoff of the scene.*

**MOVEMENT LANGUAGE**

*Use*

*sharp foot patterns;*

*synchronized stomps;*

*body percussion;*

*tool percussion;*  
*bench work;*  
*rhythmic passing of lumber;*  
*jumps over low work pieces where safe;*  
*sliding underneath beams;*  
*controlled vaults by trained performers;*  
*quick level changes;*  
*canon movement;*  
*tight unison sections;*  
*athletic turns;*  
*five-man formations that constantly break and reform.*  
*The choreography should feel as though construction itself has become dance.*  
*One man throws a lightweight piece of wood.*  
*Another catches it on count.*

**Hammer.**

*Spin.*

*Pass.*

*Duck.*

**Stomp.**

**Clap.**

**BANG!**

*Joseph lands the last strike.*

*Silence.*

*APPLAUSE BUTTON OPPORTUNITY.*

*Laughter. Breath. The men remain in the world of the workshop rather than posing for applause.*

**CALEB**

That is how you build a table.

**EZRA**

You contributed almost nothing.

**CALEB**

Morale.

**LEVI**

You were the reason morale was necessary.

*Caleb considers that.*

**CALEB**

Still counts.

*Joseph looks at the table. He is pleased despite himself.*

**MALACHI**

You're happy.

*Joseph looks at him.*

**JOSEPH**

Is that a question?

**MALACHI**

No.

*Joseph looks toward the table again, then unconsciously touches or adjusts the satchel.*

**JOSEPH**

Good.

**CALEB**

That's it?

**JOSEPH**

What?

**CALEB**

The man is getting married, building a table for half of Nazareth, and all we get is 'good.'

**LEVI**

Leave him alone.

**CALEB**

I am celebrating him.

**EZRA**

Aggressively.

**JOSEPH**

I am happy.

*That lands. Joseph does not need a speech.*

**JOSEPH**

Very.

*The others see that he means it.*

## THE BROTHERHOOD PROMISE

**CALEB**

Then remember us when you become respectable.

**JOSEPH**

Too late for you.

**CALEB**

Exactly. Someone has to protect you from it.

**LEVI**

We're finishing this tomorrow.

**EZRA**

Assuming Caleb does not improve anything overnight.

**CALEB**

You mock me now.

**MALACHI**

We mocked you this morning.

**CALEB**

Consistency. That's brotherhood.

*Small laugh.*

**JOSEPH**

When real trouble comes, you'll know the difference.

**CALEB**

Oh?

**JOSEPH**

When trouble comes, we stand together.

*The line should not become solemn. It is simply true to Joseph in this moment.*

**LEVI**

That, we can agree on.

**MALACHI**

We can.

**EZRA**

Within reason.

**CALEB**

There he goes.

*Caleb looks at Ezra and shakes his head. They laugh again.*

## MARY ARRIVES

*The men move back into the work.*

*The rhythm begins again—easy now. Familiar.*

*Joseph has his back turned.*

*At the edge of the space, MARY appears.*

*SHIRA is with her.*

*The audience sees them.*

*The men do not.*

*Mary watches Joseph laughing with his friends.*

*Completely happy.*

*The unfinished table beside him.*

*The satchel she made him still on his shoulder.*

*Shira looks at Mary.*

## SHIRA

You want me to stay?

*Mary looks at Joseph.*

*For a moment, she almost says yes.*

## MARY

No.

*Beat.*

## MARY

Thank you.

*Shira offers her hand. Mary takes it briefly.*

## SHIRA

Start with the truth.

*Mary nods.*

*Shira moves away but does not need to disappear immediately. Mary is now alone at the edge of Joseph's world.*

*The men continue working.*

## CALEB

I'm just saying, eight chairs is a commitment.

## JOSEPH

Are you still talking?

## CALEB

I have questions.



**EZRA**

No one doubts that.

**LEVI**

Leave him alone.

**CALEB**

I am leaving him alone.

**MALACHI**

You are standing next to him.

**CALEB**

Emotionally.

*Joseph laughs.*

*Then he turns.*

*He sees Mary.*

*His face immediately lights up.*

**JOSEPH**

Mary!

*That warmth should hurt.*

*Joseph crosses toward her.*

**JOSEPH**

What are you doing here?

*Then he sees her face.*

*His smile doesn't disappear immediately.*

*Concern replaces it.*

**JOSEPH**

Hey.

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**

What's wrong?

*Mary tries.*

**MARY**

Can we talk?

*Behind Joseph, the work begins to stop.*

*Caleb starts toward them.*

*Malachi catches his arm.*

**CALEB**

What?

*Malachi gives him a look.*

**CALEB**

Right.

*Levi looks at Joseph.*

*Joseph gives him the smallest nod: I've got it.*

**LEVI**

We'll finish tomorrow.

**JOSEPH**

All right.

*The men begin putting down and gathering their tools.*

*Levi starts to leave, then turns back.*

**LEVI**

Joseph.

*Joseph looks at him.*

**LEVI**

Tomorrow.

**JOSEPH**

Tomorrow.

*Levi exits.*

*Ezra and Caleb follow.*

*Malachi lingers for only a moment.*

**MALACHI**

We're here.

*Joseph nods.*

*Malachi exits.*

*The rhythm that filled the room is gone.*

*Shira looks once more toward Mary.*

*Mary gives her a small nod.*

*I'm ready.*

*Shira exits.*

**TRANSITION INTO SCENE 6**

*Mary and Joseph are alone.*

*No blackout.*

*No ominous music.*

*The LED remains warm.*

*Nothing about Nazareth has changed.*

*The unfinished table remains.*

*The satchel Mary made is still on Joseph.*

*Everything Joseph believes his future will be is physically present around him.*

*He sets down the tool in his hand.*

**JOSEPH**

Mary...

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**

What happened?

*Mary looks at him.*

*She remembers Shira's words.*

*Start with the truth.*

**MARY**

I need to tell you something.

**Scene 6 begins.**